

Schröder-Bernstein, numbers, and lists

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Let's start with one piece of unfinished business: a proof of the following theorem:

Schröder-Bernstein Theorem

For any sets A and B , if $A \lesssim B$ and $B \lesssim A$, then $A \sim B$.

We'll infer this from the following lemma:

Lemma

For any sets A and B , if $A \subseteq B$ and $B \lesssim A$, then $A \sim B$.

Lemma

For any sets A and B , if $A \subseteq B$ and $B \lesssim A$, then $A \sim B$.

Suppose $A \subseteq B$ and $B \lesssim A$. Then there is some $C \subseteq A$ such that $B \sim C$, i.e. there is a bijection $f : B \rightarrow C$. Define Z to as the **closure of $B \setminus A$ under f** . And define a function $g : B \rightarrow A$ as follows:

$$g^x = \begin{cases} fx & \text{if } x \in Z \\ x & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

This determines a function from B to A , since $B \setminus A \subseteq Z$. We will show that g is a bijection from B to A .

- To show g is injective, note that it can't happen that $gx = gy$ if $x \in Z$ and $y \notin Z$, since in that case we'd have $fx = y$ and hence $y \notin Z$ since Z is closed under f . So if $gx = gy$, either $x \in Z$ and $y \in Z$, in which case $fx = fy$ and hence $x = y$ by the injectivity of f , or $x \notin Z$ and $y \notin Z$, in which case $x = gx = gy = y$.
- To show g is surjective, consider an arbitrary $x \in A$. If $x \notin Z$ then $gx = x$ so x is in the range of g . If $x \in Z$, then x must be in $f[Z]$, since $f[Z] \cup (B \setminus A)$ is a superset of $B \setminus A$ closed under f , hence a superset of Z . Thus there exists $y \in Z$ such that $fy = x$ and thus $gy = x$.

Notation: when $f : X \rightarrow Y$ and $Z \subseteq X$, $f[Z] := \{fx \mid x \in Z\}$.

Finally we need to get to the actual theorem:

Schröder-Bernstein Theorem

For any sets A and B , if $A \lesssim B$ and $B \lesssim A$, then $A \sim B$.

So, suppose we have injections $f : A \rightarrow B$ and $g : B \rightarrow A$. We have $f[A] \subseteq B$. Also since $f[A] \sim A$, $B \lesssim f[A]$. So by the lemma, $f[A] \sim B$, hence $A \sim B$.

Numbers and Lists

The Axiom of Numbers (recap)

The Axiom of Numbers

$\mathbb{N}$ is a set (the set of natural numbers), 0 is an element of $\mathbb{N}$, and suc is a function $\mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$, such that:

Inductive Property $\mathbb{N}$ is the closure of $\{0\}$ under suc .

Injective Property (a) suc is injective.
(b) 0 is not in the range of suc .

Notation: we write '1' for $\text{suc } 0$, '2' for $\text{suc}(\text{suc } 0)$, etc.

Remark: given our definition of addition, we can prove that $\text{suc } n = n + 1$ for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$; once this is proved, we can feel free to write ' $n + 1$ ' instead of ' $\text{suc } n$ ' if we prefer.

Let's just prove that last fact. Recall that $n + m$ is short for $\text{add}_n m$, where add_n is the unique function $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$ such that $f0 = n$ and $f(\text{suc } m) = \text{suc}(fm)$ for any $m \in \mathbb{N}$ (where we are assured of the existence of such a function by the Recursion Theorem). The definition thus secures the following two *recursion clauses* (for all $n, m \in \mathbb{N}$):

$$(i) \qquad n + 0 = n$$

$$(ii) \qquad n + \text{suc } m = \text{suc}(n + m)$$

Proposition

For all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $n + 1 = \text{suc } n$.

Proof: $n + 1 = n + \text{suc } 0 = \text{suc}(n + 0)$ (by (ii)) $= \text{suc } n$ (by (i)).

The Axiom of Lists

The Axiom of Lists

For every set A , there is a set A^* (the set of finite lists of elements of A); an element $[]$ of A^* , and a family $(\text{cons}_a)_{a \in A}$ of functions $A^* \rightarrow A^*$, such that:

Inductive Property A^* is the closure of $\{[]\}$ under $(\text{cons}_a)_{a \in A}$.

Injective Property

- (a) each cons_a is injective.
- (b) $[]$ is not in the range of any cons_a .
- (c) when $a \neq b$, the ranges of cons_a and cons_b do not overlap.

Notation: we write $a : s$ instead of $\text{cons}_a s$ (for $a \in A, s \in A^*$).

Notation: we write $[a]$ for $a : []$, $[a, b]$ for $a : (b : [])$, $[a, b, c]$ for $a : (b : (c : []))$, etc.

Notation: when A is a set of characters in some alphabet, we write $***$.

Recursive definitions for lists

Intuively, the Injective Property for lists means that every element of A^* can be constructed in *at most one way* by starting with $[]$ and applying the functions cons_a (for $a \in A$).

This gives us the following (which we'll prove later):

Recursion Theorem for Lists

Suppose B is a set; $z \in B$; and for every $a \in A$, $s_a : B \rightarrow B$. Then there is a *unique* function $f : A^* \rightarrow B$ such that $f[] = z$ and for all $t \in A^*$, $f(\text{cons}_a t) = s_a(ft)$.

Compare this with the following, stated last week:

Recursion Theorem for Numbers

Suppose B is a set; $z \in B$; and $s : B \rightarrow B$. Then there is a *unique* function $f : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow B$ such that $f0 = z$ and for all $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $f(\text{suc } n) = s(fn)$.

The Recursion Theorem for Lists at work

For example, the following counts as a definition:

Definition

For any A , let length be the function $A^* \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$ such that $\text{length}[] = 0$ and $\text{length}(\text{cons}_a s) = \text{suc}(\text{length } s)$ for all $a \in A, s \in A^*$.

The Recursion Theorem for Lists assures us that there is a unique function $A^* \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$ meeting these conditions.

The Recursion Theorem for Lists at work

Definition

For any A , let `elements` be the function $A^* \rightarrow \mathcal{P}A$ such that `elements`[] = $\emptyset$ and `elements`(`consa s`) = `elements s` $\cup$ { a } for all $a \in A, s \in A^*$.

Definition

For any A and any $t \in A^*$ let `concatt` be the function $A^* \rightarrow A^*$ such that `concatt`[] = t and `concatt`(`consa s`) = `consa`(`concatt s`) for all $a \in A, s \in A^*$.

Notation: we write ' $s \oplus t$ ' for '`concatt s`', so the two clauses can be written as:

$$\begin{aligned} [] \oplus t &= t \\ (a : s) \oplus t &= a : (s \oplus t) \end{aligned}$$

Proofs by induction about lists

Thanks to the Inductive Property in the Axiom of Lists, we can prove that every element of A^* has a certain property ϕ by proving:

- ▶ Base Case: $[]$ has ϕ .
- ▶ Induction Step: for all $s \in A^*$, if s has ϕ , then for all $a \in A$, $a : s$ has ϕ .

Example

For all $s, t \in A^*$, $\text{length}(s \oplus t) = \text{length } t + \text{length } s$.

Proof: By induction on s . Base case:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{length}([] \oplus t) &= \text{length } t \\ &= \text{length } t + 0 \\ &= \text{length } t + \text{length}[]\end{aligned}$$

Induction step: suppose $\text{length}(s \oplus t) = \text{length } t + \text{length } s$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}\text{length}((a : s) \oplus t) &= \text{length}(a : (s \oplus t)) \\ &= \text{suc}(\text{length}(s \oplus t)) \\ &= \text{suc}(\text{length } t + \text{length } s) \\ &= \text{length } t + \text{suc}(\text{length } s) \\ &= \text{length } t + \text{length}(a : s)\end{aligned}$$

The Recursion Theorem

The Recursion Theorem

The Recursion Theorem

Suppose that C is the closure of $B \subseteq A$ under a family $(R_i)_{i \in I}$ of relations on A and a family $(S_k)_{k \in K}$ of relations from $A \times A$ to A , such that

- (i) Each R_i and S_k is injective.
- (ii) The ranges of the R_i and S_i are all disjoint from one another and from B .

Suppose we have $z : B \rightarrow D$; $s_i : D \rightarrow D$ for each $i \in I$, and $t_k : D^2 \rightarrow D$ for each $k \in K$. Then there is a unique function $f : C \rightarrow D$ such that

- a. $fx = zx$ for all $x \in B$.
- b. Whenever $R_i xy$, $fy = s_i(fx)$.
- c. Whenever $S_k \langle x, y \rangle z$, $fz = t_k \langle fx, fy \rangle$.

Proving the Recursion Theorem

Proof: For each R_i , let R_i^+ be the relation on $C \times D$ such that $R_i^+ \langle x, u \rangle \langle y, v \rangle$ iff $R_i xy$ and $v = s_i u$, and for each S_k , let S_k^+ be the relation from $(C \times D)^2$ to $C \times D$ such that $S_k^+ \langle \langle x, u \rangle, \langle y, v \rangle \rangle \langle z, w \rangle$ iff $S_k \langle x, y \rangle z$ and $w = t_k \langle u, v \rangle$.

Let F be the closure of z under (R_i^+) and (S_k^+) . We will prove that F is a function from C to D . This suffices to prove the theorem, since clearly we have:

- $Fx(zx)$ for all $x \in B$ (since $z \subseteq F$).
- Whenever $R_i xy$ and Fxu , $Fy(s_i u)$ (since in that case $R_i^+ \langle x, u \rangle \langle y, s_i u \rangle$, and F is closed under R_i^+).
- Whenever $S_k \langle x, y \rangle z$, Fxu , and Fyv , $Fz(t_k \langle u, v \rangle)$ (since in that case $S_k^+ \langle \langle x, u \rangle, \langle y, v \rangle \rangle \langle z, t_k \langle u, v \rangle \rangle$, and F is closed under S_k^+).

Moreover $F \subseteq F'$ for any other relation F' meeting these three conditions, and so $F = F'$ for any other *function* F' meeting these three conditions (since no function is a subset of any other function with the same domain).

Proving the Recursion Theorem

(i) F is serial, i.e. for all $x \in C$ there exists $u \in D$ such that Fxu . By induction.

Base case: if $x \in B$ then $Fx(zx)$: case (a) from the previous slide.

Induction step for R_i : if Fxu and R_ixy , then $Fy(s_iu)$: case (b) from the previous slide.

Induction step for S_k : suppose Fxu , Fyv , and $S_k\langle x, y \rangle z$. Then $Fz(t_k\langle u, v \rangle)$: case (c) from the previous slide

Proving the Recursion Theorem

(ii) F is functional, i.e. for any $x \in C$, if Fxu and Fxv then $u = v$. By induction.

Base case: suppose $x \in B$. Then since x isn't in the range of any R_i or S_k , no ordered pair $\langle x, u \rangle$ is in the range of any R_i^+ or S_k^+ . So if $\langle x, u \rangle$ and $\langle x, v \rangle$ are in F , they are both in z , and hence $u = v$ since z is functional.

Induction step for R_i : suppose that x is F -related to a unique u , R_ixy , and Fyv . We will show that $v = s_i u$. Since y isn't in B , isn't in the range of any R_j for $j \neq i$, and isn't in the range of any S_k , $\langle y, v \rangle$ isn't in z , isn't in the range of any R^+j for $j \neq i$, and isn't in the range of any S_k^+ . So it must be in the range of R_i^+ : i.e.

$R_i^+ \langle x', u' \rangle \langle y, v \rangle$ for some $x' \in C$, $u' \in D$. But then $R_ix'y$, hence $x' = x$ (since R_i is injective), hence $u' = u$ (by the induction hypothesis), hence $v = s_i u$ (by the definition of R_i^+).

Proving the Recursion Theorem

Induction step for S_k : suppose that x is F -related to a unique u , y is F -related to a unique v , $S_k\langle x, y \rangle z$, and Fzw . We will show that $v = t_k\langle u, v \rangle$. Since z isn't in B , isn't in the range of any R_i , and isn't in the range of S_j for $j \neq k$, $\langle z, w \rangle$ isn't in z , isn't in the range of any R^+_i for $i \neq k$, and isn't in the range of any S^+_k . So it must be in the range of S^+_k : i.e. $S^+_i\langle\langle x', u' \rangle, \langle y', v' \rangle\rangle\langle z, w \rangle$ for some $x', y' \in C$, $u', v' \in D$. But then $S_k\langle x', y' \rangle z$, hence $x' = x$ and $y' = y$ since S_k is injective, hence $u' = u$ and $v' = v$ by the induction hypothesis, hence $w = t_k\langle u, v \rangle$ by the definition of S^+_k .